



# Victor H. Aguiar

Curriculum Vitae

Updated August 2026

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## Contact & Identity

**Email** [vaguiarl@sfu.ca](mailto:vaguiarl@sfu.ca)

**Website** [vaguiarl.github.io](https://vaguiarl.github.io)

**LinkedIn** Victor Aguiar, Ph.D.

**Citizenship** Ecuador; Canada

**Location** Greater Vancouver Area, BC, Canada

**Scholar** [Google Scholar profile](#)

**Languages:** Trilingual in English, French, and Spanish.

## Current Positions

### Associate Professor of Economics

January 2024 - present

*Simon Fraser University, Greater Vancouver Area, BC, Canada*

- Research and teaching across microeconomic theory, structural econometrics, computational economics, and AI.

## Profile & Philosophy

- Work across decision theory, structural econometrics, AI, and product science to build systems that learn what drives people's choices.
- Build consideration-aware algorithms and scalable substitution models for markets with millions of products and continuous experimentation.
- Bridge academic rigor with product velocity, boutique problem solving, and public science diffusion, with particular emphasis on making generative AI legible and useful.

## Education

| Degree | Field                                         | Institution                                                | Year |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| Ph.D.  | Economics                                     | Brown University                                           | 2017 |
| M.A.   | Development Economics (Valedictorian)         | Latin American Faculty of Social Sciences (FLACSO Ecuador) | 2012 |
| M.A.   | Public Administration and International Trade | Université Pierre Mendès France                            | 2011 |
| B.Sc.  | Economics (Valedictorian)                     | Catholic University of Ecuador                             | 2010 |

**Dissertation:** Bounded Rationality, Consumer Theory, and Revealed Preferences

**Committee:** Roberto Serrano, Susanne Schennach, Geoffroy de Clippel

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Research

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## Current Working Papers

**Tabular Foundation Models and the Unity of Economic Behaviour**

August 2026

Victor H. Aguiar

A unified choice experiment and structural model spanning risk, time, loss, valuation, and social-choice domains. [\[paper\]](#)**GARP-EFM: Improving Foundation Models with Revealed Preference Structure**

March 2026

Victor H. Aguiar and Nail Kashaev

Uses revealed-preference structure to improve foundation-model prediction while preserving economic discipline. [\[paper\]](#)**A Rationalization of the Weak Axiom of Revealed Preference**

2025

Victor H. Aguiar, Per Hjertstrand, Roberto Serrano, and Özgür Evren

Second-round revision at *The Economic Journal*. Includes k-acyclicity, counterfactual existence, and an ordinal representation theorem. [\[paper\]](#)**Entangled vs. Separable Choice**

July 2026

Nail Kashaev, Martin Plávala, and Victor H. Aguiar

Finite, nonparametric tests distinguish separable local responses from coordinated joint choice that can pass no-signaling checks, using CHSH inequalities in the binary case and virtual-replica restrictions more generally. [\[paper\]](#)**Dynamic and Stochastic Rational Behavior**

April 2023

Victor H. Aguiar, Charles Gauthier, Nail Kashaev, and Martin Plávala

Dynamic random utility with changing individual preferences and stable population-level choice distributions. [\[paper\]](#)**Estimating High Dimensional Demand under Bounded Rationality: The ESMAX Demand System**

May 2020

Victor H. Aguiar and Nikolai Riabov

High-dimensional demand estimation under bounded rationality. [\[paper\]](#)

## Publications

**A New Look at the Symmetry of the Slutsky Matrix**

2025

Victor H. Aguiar and Roberto Serrano

*Journal of Political Economy Microeconomics*, 3(2), 289-302. [\[paper\]](#)**Identification and Estimation of Discrete Choice Models with Unobserved Choice Sets**

2025

Victor H. Aguiar and Nail Kashaev

*Journal of Business & Economic Statistics*, 43(1), 204-215. [\[paper\]](#) [\[replication\]](#)**Random Utility and Limited Consideration**

2023

Victor H. Aguiar, María José Boccardi, Nail Kashaev, and Jeongbin Kim

*Quantitative Economics*, 14(1), 71-116. Top-cited paper in the journal. [\[paper\]](#) [\[replication\]](#)**Prices, Profits, Proxies, and Production**

2023

Victor H. Aguiar, Nail Kashaev, and Roy Allen

*Journal of Econometrics*, 235(2), 666-693. [\[paper\]](#)**A Random Attention and Utility Model**

2022

Victor H. Aguiar and Nail Kashaev

*Journal of Economic Theory*, 105487. [\[paper\]](#)**Stochastic Revealed Preferences with Measurement Error**

2021

Victor H. Aguiar and Nail Kashaev

*Review of Economic Studies*, 88(4), 2042-2093. [\[paper\]](#)**Cardinal Revealed Preference: Disentangling Transitivity and Consistent Binary Choice**

2021

Victor H. Aguiar and Roberto Serrano

*Journal of Mathematical Economics*, 94, 102462.

**Adaptive Stochastic Search**

2019

Victor H. Aguiar and Mert Kimya

*Journal of Mathematical Economics*, 81, 74-83.**A Non-Parametric Approach to Testing the Axioms of the Shapley Value with Limited Data**

2018

Victor H. Aguiar, Roland Pongou, and Jean-Baptiste Tondji

*Games and Economic Behavior*, 111, 41-63.**Slutsky Matrix Norms: The Size, Classification, and Comparative Statics of Bounded Rationality**

2017

Victor H. Aguiar and Roberto Serrano

*Journal of Economic Theory*, 172, 163-201.**Satisficing and Stochastic Choice**

2016

Victor H. Aguiar, María José Boccardi, and Mark Dean

*Journal of Economic Theory*, 166, 445-482.**Short Papers and Book Chapter**

- **Random Rank-Dependent Expected Utility.** With Nail Kashaev. *Games*, 13(1):13, 2022.
- **Classifying Bounded Rationality in Limited Data Sets: A Slutsky Matrix Approach.** With Roberto Serrano. *SERIEs*, 9(4), 389-421, 2018.
- **Random Categorization and Bounded Rationality.** *Economics Letters*, 159, 46-52, 2017.
- **An Index of Unfairness.** With Roland Pongou, Roberto Serrano, and Jean-Baptiste Tondji. In *Handbook of the Shapley Value*, CRC Press, 2019.

**Selected Work before the Ph.D.**

- **El mercado laboral ecuatoriano, propuesta de una reforma.** Mimeo, 2007.
- **Una nueva política fiscal para el Buen Vivir.** With coauthors. Servicio de Rentas Internas Ecuador, Abya-Yala, 2012.
- **Análisis de la reforma tributaria en el Ecuador, 2001-2012.** With Luis Castro and Mayra Sánchez. CEPAL, Serie Macroeconomía del Desarrollo, 2014.

**Honors, Editorial Roles & Recognition**

- George Borts Prize, awarded by the Brown University Department of Economics in recognition of an outstanding Ph.D. dissertation, 2016.
- Associate Editor, *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization* (JEBO), through March 2026.
- Excellence in Refereeing, *Review of Economic Studies* (for 2023; announced 2025).
- Wiley top cited paper recognition for *Random Utility and Limited Consideration* in *Quantitative Economics*.
- Christopher J. Grimes Faculty Fellowship in Microeconomic Theory, Western University, 2021 to 2026.
- Graduate Economics Professor of the Year, Western University, 2017.

**Skills & Interests**

**Economics and decision science:** microeconomic theory; decision theory; structural econometrics; computational economics; structural microeconometrics; customer modelling; demand and substitution; causal inference; policy analysis.

**AI, product science, and engineering:** foundation models; generative AI; machine learning; experimentation; scalable computation and data engineering; PySpark; PyTorch; Python; Julia; SQL.

**Practice:** boutique problem solving; public science diffusion; product strategy; technical communication; consulting across private, public, and multilateral settings.

**Industry & Academic Experience****Senior Economist, Stores Economics & Science (SEAS)**

May 2025 - May 2026

*Amazon, Seattle, WA, USA; previously Core-AI and Central Econ*

- Worked at the intersection of decision theory, structural econometrics, and AI on algorithms that model consideration and scalable substitution systems.
- Built for markets with millions of products and continuous experimentation, connecting customer modelling, computation, and product decisions.

**Associate Professor of Economics (with tenure)**

July 2021 - December 2023

Western University

**Assistant Professor of Economics**

July 2016 - June 2021

Western University

**Consulting****World Bank**

2012; 2014-2016

- Technical notes and economic analysis for the Ecuador Skills Development Strategy for Social Inclusion and the Ecuador Country Economic Memorandum.
- Work on labor forces, markets, local and international migration, and economic analysis.

**Government, Multilateral, and NGO Work - Ecuador and EU partnerships**

2009-2012

- European Commission: income mobility and labor markets using pseudo-panel GMM; VARX business-cycle monitoring and early-warning systems.
- Ministry of Coordination of Economic Policy: advisor to the Minister; multilateral trade simulation and early-warning models with the EU mission.
- SENPLADES, GTZ, and SRI: fiscal-effort estimation, decentralization, tax-incidence analysis, and social-mobility evaluation.
- Conservation International and Ministry of Social Development: monitoring and evaluation methods for Socio Bosque and the Human Development Credit program.
- GIZ: local tax reform and efficiency/equity assessment; MIPRO-FLACSO Center for Research on SMEs: Academic Director.

**Selected Presentations**

**Recent seminars:** University of Maryland (2024); Purdue University (2024); University of Tokyo Microeconomic Theory Workshop (2024); Simon Fraser University; Columbia Business School; Cornell; Caltech; NYU; University of Michigan; University of Toronto; University of Montreal; Arizona State University; Tilburg; Bristol-Warwick; Virginia Tech; UC Riverside.

**Conferences and workshops:** Econometric Society World Congress, Seoul (2025); SAET, Paris (2023); ASSA Econometric Society, San Diego (2020); BGSE Summer Forum on Stochastic Choice (2019); SAET, Naples (2019); IWABE, Brussels (2019); CIREQ Micro Theory Conference (2018); BRIC 6, Columbia (2018); Econometric Society World Congress, Montreal (2015).

**Teaching & Mentoring**

**Simon Fraser University:** International Trade; Microeconomic Theory I; Computational Methods in Economics.

**Western University:** Microeconomics I (Ph.D.); Mathematics for Economists (Ph.D. review); Advanced Microeconomics I; Intermediate Microeconomics; Behavioral Economics; Behavioral Economics and Revealed Preferences.

**Brown University:** Teaching assistant for Mathematics for First-Year Ph.D., Behavioral Economics, and Financial Institutions.

**Graduate supervision and mentoring:** Supervisor - Charles Gauthier. Committee and advising roles for Terrence Adam Rooney, Meghdad Rahimian, Dazhuo Wei, Hans Martinez, Wang Chong, and Wilfred Youmbi; undergraduate mentoring for Rachel Cheng and Aaron Leonard.

**Refereeing & Service**

**Refereeing:** *Econometrica*; *American Economic Review*; *Review of Economic Studies*; *Quarterly Journal of Economics*; *Journal of Political Economy*; *Journal of Economic Theory*; *American Economic Journal: Microeconomics*; *Journal of Public Economics*; *Journal of Mathematical Economics*; *Journal of Business & Economic Statistics*; *International Journal of Game Theory*; *Economics Letters*; *Canadian Journal of Economics* (Senior Advisor); and others.

**Selected service:** Co-Director, Economic Theory Workshop; Micro Ph.D. Comprehensive Committee; Appointments Committee; Graduate Affairs Committee; Department Representative at Convocation, Western University.